

NICKY HAWKINS · PAINTER & DECORATOR

NH Estimator User Manual

A pocket guide to the paint-estimating app, from first measure to final invoice — measuring rooms, staircases and exteriors, pricing wallpaper and kitchen resprays, quoting through Xero, scheduling, and running the job on site.

App version 2.2.5 · Manual generated August 2026
Screenshots taken from the app with example data

NH Estimator is a phone-first web app for pricing decorating work. You walk round the property measuring up, and the app turns those measurements into a fully priced quote — labour, materials, markup, deposit and payment plan — which you can send straight into Xero. Once a quote is accepted, the same app schedules the job, tracks the materials and time you actually use on site, and builds the final invoice back into Xero when you're done.

This manual follows the life of a job in order: **set up → measure → quote → schedule → on site → invoice**. If you're brand new, read [Getting started](#) and [Measuring up](#) first — the rest will make sense as you need it.

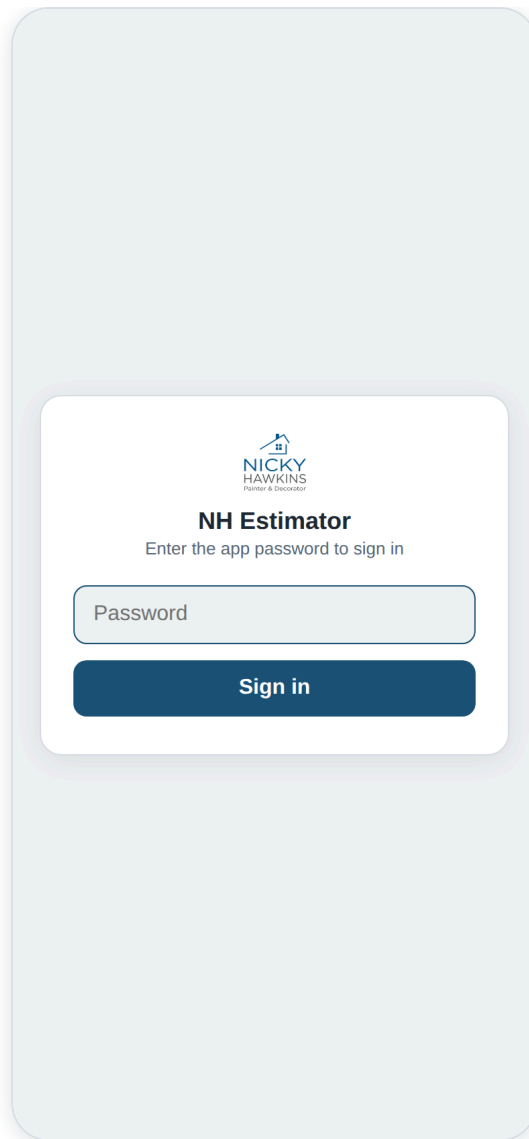
1. Getting started

Install it on your phone

The app lives at your own web address (the one on your Render account). It's designed to be **installed to your home screen** so it opens full-screen like a normal app:

- **iPhone:** open the app in Safari → tap the Share button → **Add to Home Screen**.
- **Android:** open it in Chrome → menu (⋮) → **Add to Home screen / Install app**.

If your copy of the app has a password set, you'll be asked for it the first time you open the app on a device — after that it stays signed in. If there's no password on your instance, guard the web address like you would any private page.



Connect Xero (one-off)

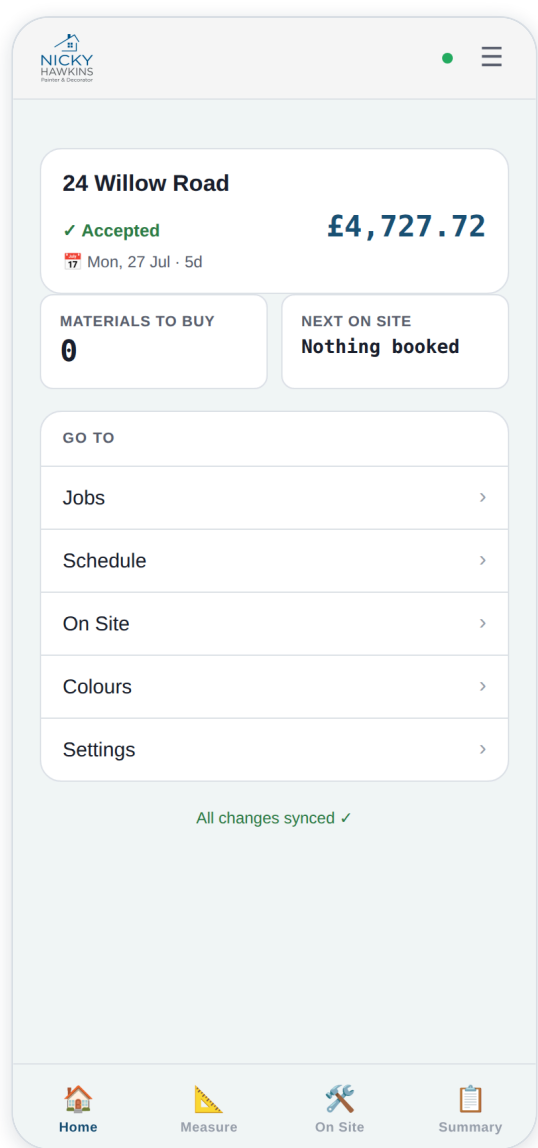
Almost everything works without Xero, but quoting and invoicing shine with it connected:

1. Open the menu (☰) → **Settings**.
2. Scroll to **Xero Integration** → tap **Connect Xero** and sign in.
3. Back in Settings, under **Materials (Xero Items)**, tap **Refresh from Xero** to pull in your paint products, then pick your default products (wall paint, ceiling, woodwork, primer, mist coat, masonry...). Every new room starts with these defaults, so set them once and forget them.

Check your rates

Settings is pre-loaded with sensible defaults (day rate £300, 20% markup, 25% deposit, standard coverage rates). Skim through [Settings](#) once and adjust anything that doesn't match how you price — every figure in a quote comes from these numbers.

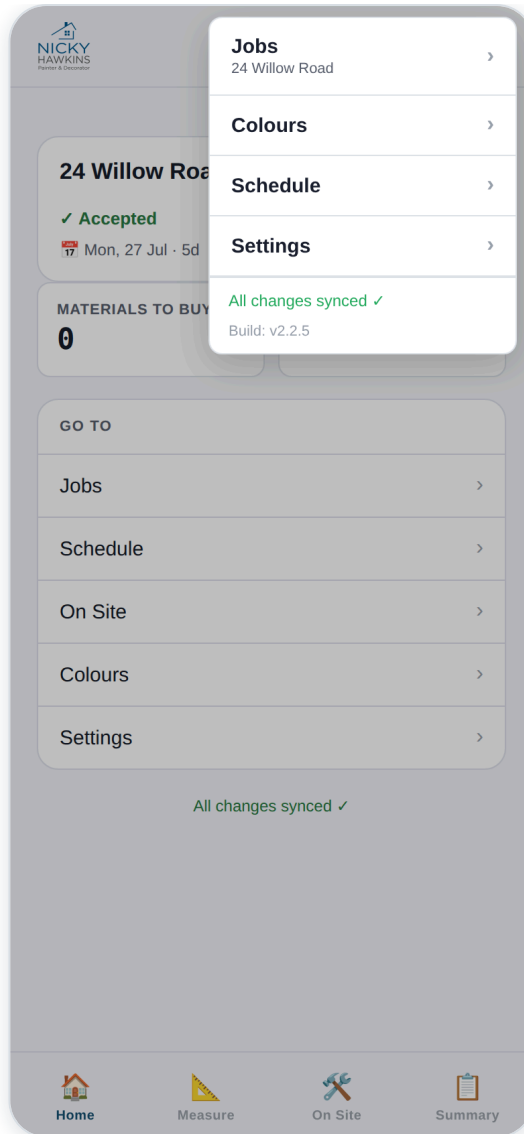
2. Finding your way around



The **Home** screen is your morning glance: the current job and its status, a **Materials to buy** count, what's **next on site**, and shortcut links. When something needs chasing — a quote that's gone unanswered too long, a finished job you haven't invoiced — it appears at the top of Home as an attention strip.

The **bottom bar** is always visible and follows the life of a job, left to right:

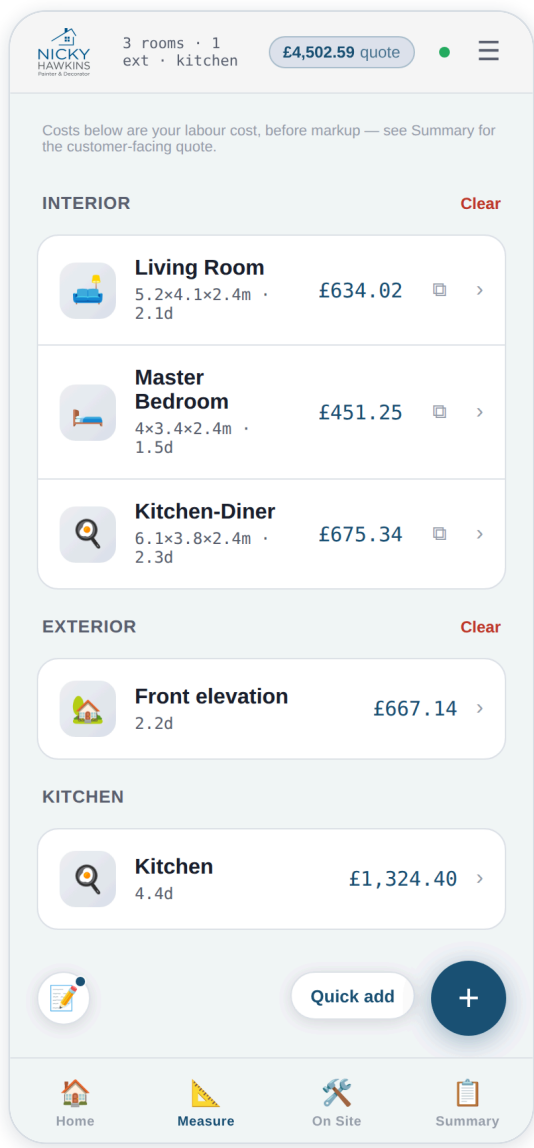
Tab	What it's for
 Home	Dashboard and reminders
 Measure	Everything measured for the current job — rooms, exterior items and the kitchen respray
 On Site	Time, materials and variations while the job runs
 Summary	The priced quote, Xero, and job status



The **menu** (☰), top right on most screens, holds the job-admin screens: **Jobs**, **Colours**, **Schedule** and **Settings**, plus a sync line — "All changes synced ✓" means everything you've entered is safely on the server. Everything saves automatically as you type; there is no save button to forget.

3. Measuring up

Open  **Measure**. This screen lists everything measured for the current job — **Interior** rooms, **Exterior** items and the **Kitchen** respray — each showing its cost and estimated days at a glance. The figures on this screen are your *labour cost before markup* (the banner at the top says so); the chip in the top bar shows the customer-facing quote total, and Summary has the full customer-facing breakdown.



Tap the  **button** (bottom right) and choose what you're adding — a room, an exterior item, or the kitchen:



3 rooms · 1
ext · kitchen

£4,502.59 quote

Costs below are your labour cost, before markup — see Summary for the customer-facing quote.

INTERIOR

Clear



Living Room
5.2×4.1×2.4m ·
2.1d

£634.02

 >



Master Bedroom
4×3.4×2.4m ·
1.5d

£451.25

 >



Kitchen-Diner
6.1×3.8×2.4m ·
2.3d

£675.34

 >

EXTERIOR

Clear



Front elevation
2.2d

£667.14

>

KITCHEN



Kitchen
4.4d

£1,324.40

>

 Room >

 Exterior item >

 Kitchen >

Quick add: walking a big house? Tap **Quick add** instead and just type the room names one after another — Living Room, Hall, Bedroom 1... — then go back round measuring each one on a second pass. Much faster than filling in a full form in every doorway.

NH Estimator — User Manual

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Adding a room

The screenshot shows the 'Add Room' form in the NH Estimator app. The form is organized into three main sections: ROOM DETAILS, DIMENSIONS, and COATS. At the top, there is a back arrow and the title 'Add Room', and a 'Save' button. The ROOM DETAILS section includes a 'Room Name' field with the value 'Living Room' and a 'Staircase / HSL' toggle switch, which is currently turned off. The DIMENSIONS section includes three input fields: 'Length' (5.2 metres), 'Width' (4.1 metres), and 'Height' (2.4 metres). The COATS section includes three input fields: 'Walls', 'Ceiling', and 'Woodwork', each with a numeric input set to 2. A bottom navigation bar contains four icons: Home, Measure, On Site, and Summary.

The form works top to bottom, and only the top matters for a basic room:

1. **Room Name** — e.g. "Living Room".
2. **Dimensions** — length, width and height in metres (height starts at 2.4 m). The app works out wall and ceiling areas itself. (The **Staircase / HSL** toggle above swaps this card for staircase geometry — see [Staircases](#) below.)
3. **Coats** — walls, ceiling and woodwork each default to 2. Set any of them to 0 to skip that surface entirely (e.g. ceiling not being painted). The **Spray walls** toggle lives here too — flick it to price the walls for spraying rather than brush and roller.

Then the optional sections, which you'll use as the room demands:

- **Feature Wall** — one wall in a different finish: paint, or wallpaper (standard, wide vinyl or mural).
- **Excluded Walls** — walls you're *not* painting (a tiled wall, wallpaper that's staying). Add its width × height and it's deducted.

- **Doors & Frames** — doors and their frames are priced separately, each with its own quantity and coats. Painting one side or both? The **Both sides** toggle prices the whole leaf; off, you're pricing just the face seen from this room — so a door between two painted rooms can be split across them.
- **Extras** — windows (m²), window sills and radiators. Each adds its own time and paint.
- **Wallpaper** — lining and finish paper for walls or ceiling, priced per roll with an automatic **rolls-to-order** count. Covered in detail in [Wallpaper](#) below.
- **Mist Coat** — for fresh plaster; tick walls and/or ceiling.
- **Panelling** — wall panelling by area with its own coats, prep and colour.
- **Preparation** — Minimal / Standard / Heavy, or a custom percentage. This scales labour. **Making Good** adds a fixed £ amount for repairs.
- **Paint & Colour** — each surface takes your default product from Settings; override the product, colour band or colour here when a room is different.

A **Preview** card at the bottom shows the wall/ceiling areas and this room's estimated cost and time as you type, so you can sanity-check before you leave the room. Tap **Save** (top right) when you're happy. To change a room later, tap it in the Measure list; **Delete Room** is at the bottom of the edit form.

Staircases (Hall, Stairs & Landing)

Stairwells are the hardest thing to measure by hand — big raking walls you can't get a tape across, hall and landing running into each other. The app does the geometry for you. Flick the **Staircase / HSL** toggle at the top of the room form and the Dimensions card is replaced with staircase geometry:

Add Room Save

ROOM DETAILS

Room Name Hall, Stairs

Staircase / HSL
Hall, stairs & landing — swaps in staircase geometry below ☒

NUMBER OF FLOORS

Floors 1 2 3
inc ground floor

GROUND FLOOR HALL

Length 4.2
metres

Width 1.9
metres

Height 2.4
metres

STAIRCASE 1

Stair walls 1 2
how many sides get painted

Home **Measure** **On Site** **Summary**

Work down the cards:

1. **Number of Floors** — 1, 2 or 3 including the ground floor. A typical two-storey house is **2**: ground-floor hall, one staircase, first-floor landing. Choose 3 and a second staircase and landing appear.
2. **Ground Floor Hall** — plain length × width × height, like any room.
3. **Staircase 1** — this is where the app earns its keep:

The screenshot shows the 'Add Room' screen in the NH Estimator app. At the top, there is a back arrow, the title 'Add Room', and a 'Save' button. The screen is divided into several sections for inputting staircase and landing data.

Stair walls
how many sides get painted. A toggle switch is set to '1'.

Steps
count as you go up. Value: 13.

Stair width
metres — physical width of the stairs. Value: 0.9.

Wall height at bottom
metres. Value: 2.4.

Riser
default 220mm. Value: 0.22.

Tread
default 220mm. Value: 0.22.

Top step
metres — measure at the top, see diagram. Value: 0.25.

1ST FLOOR LANDING

Length
metres. Value: 3.0.

Width
metres. Value: 1.9.

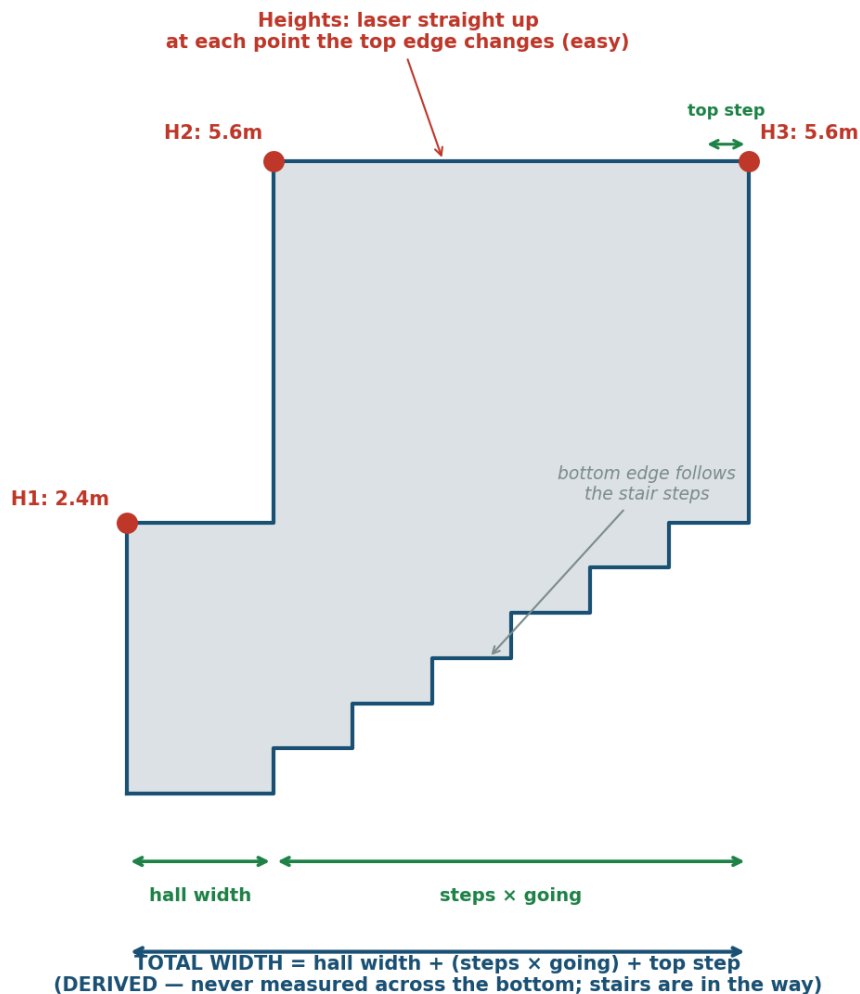
Height
metres. Value: 2.4.

At the bottom, there is a navigation bar with four icons: Home (house), Measure (ruler), On Site (wrench and screwdriver), and Summary (clipboard).

- **Stair walls** — how many sides of the staircase get painted (1 or 2).
- **Steps** — count them as you go up.
- **Stair width** — the physical width of the stairs.
- **Wall height at bottom** — floor to ceiling at the foot of the stairs.
- **Riser** and **Tread** — pre-filled with the standard 220 mm; only touch these on an unusual staircase.
- **Top step** — the one measurement people get wrong, so it has its own diagram:

WALL 1 — Large raking stair wall: DERIVE the width, MEASURE the heights

Width is built UP from the bottom (hall + steps), NOT measured across the top — the upstairs landing length overlaps the stairwell void and double-counts. This avoids that error.



The trick, as the diagram shows, is that the big raking stair wall's width is **derived, never measured**: hall width + (steps × going) + top step. Measuring across the top instead double-counts the stairwell void; measuring along the bottom is impossible because the stairs are in the way. You measure only the easy things — heights straight up with a laser — and the app builds the wall from the step geometry.

4. **1st Floor Landing** (and 2nd, for three floors) — plain length × width × height again.
5. **Staircase Details** — spindles, newel posts and their woodwork coats. These are priced per piece on top of the ordinary skirtings and doors.

The **Staircase Areas** card at the bottom shows its working — so you can see exactly what you're pricing and sanity-check it against the space you're standing in:

←

Add Room

Save

PANELLING

PREPARATION

PAINT & COLOUR

STAIRCASE AREAS

Hall wall area	29.28 m ²
Stair 1 wall width derived — hall width + steps + top step	5.01 m
Staircase 1 walls	13.23 m ²
1st floor landing walls	23.52 m ²
Total ceiling area	13.68 m ²
Total wall area	66.03 m²
Woodwork (doors, frames & skirtings)	£125.71
Staircase woodwork	£240.45
Estimated cost (ex markup)	£821.53
Estimated time	2.74 days

Home

Measure

On Site

Summary

Here the derived stair wall width is 5.01 m (1.9 m hall + 13 steps × 0.22 m + 0.25 m top step), giving 13.23 m² of raking stair wall on top of the hall's 29.28 m² and the landing's 23.52 m² — a 66 m² job in total, priced at 2.74 days, without a tape measure going anywhere near the stairwell.

Wallpaper & rolls to order

Any room (including a staircase) can have wallpaper on the walls, the ceiling, or both. Open the **Wallpaper** section of the room form:

The screenshot shows the 'Add Room' screen of an app. At the top, there's a back arrow and 'Add Room' title, and a 'Save' button. The main content area has several sections:

- Walls:** A section with a note 'both can be on — e.g. line out then finish' and two buttons: 'Lining' and 'Finish'.
- Wall wallpaper labour:** A row showing '£780.00'.
- Rolls to order:** A section with a note 'does not feed the quote total — client buys the paper'.
- Roll length:** A field with '10.05' and a note 'metres — check the label'.
- Roll width:** A field with '0.53' and a note 'metres — check the label'.
- Pattern match:** Three buttons: 'No match', 'Straight' (selected), and 'Offset'.
- Pattern repeat:** A field with '32' and a note 'cm — off the roll label'.
- Spare roll:** A toggle switch that is turned on, with a note 'order one extra, just in case'.
- Drop length:** A row showing 'Lining 2.50 m · Finish 2.82 m'.
- Drops per roll / needed:** A row showing 'Lining 4 / 33 · Finish 3 / 33'.
- Rolls to order:** A row showing 'Lining 10 · Finish 12'.
- Ceiling:** A section with a note 'both can be on — e.g. line out then finish' and two buttons: 'Lining' and 'Finish'.

At the bottom, there's a navigation bar with four icons: 'Home' (house), 'Measure' (ruler), 'On Site' (wrench and screwdriver), and 'Summary' (clipboard).

- **Lining / Finish** — tap either or both. Both on means "line out, then hang finish paper", and each is priced separately per roll (rates in Settings → Wallpaper Rates). The labour appears immediately — £780.00 for this dining room's walls.
- **Roll length / Roll width** — pre-filled with the standard 10.05 m × 0.53 m; check the label of the actual paper and adjust.
- **Pattern match** — *No match* (lining papers, plains), *Straight* or *Offset*. A pattern match wastes paper, and the calculation accounts for it.
- **Pattern repeat** — in cm, straight off the roll label.
- **Spare roll** — adds one extra to the order, just in case.

Below the inputs the app shows its working, batch-book style: the **drop length** (wall height plus trim allowance, lengthened to allow for the pattern repeat when there's a match), **drops per roll / drops needed**, and the bottom line — **Rolls to order** (here: 10 lining, 12 finish, including the spare). Read that to the client off your phone.

Two things worth knowing:

- The rolls figure is a **buying guide, not a charge** — the labour feeds the quote; the client buys the paper. (It says so right under the heading.)

- On a staircase/HSL room, wallpaper labour automatically picks up the **staircase multiplier** from Settings — hanging over a stairwell is slower and the price reflects it. Ceilings get their own multiplier the same way.

For a single papered **feature wall**, use the Feature Wall section instead — it has its own wallpaper option including wide vinyl and mural pricing.

Adding an exterior item

Add Exterior Save

LABEL

Description
e.g. Front elevation, Rear fascias Front elevat

MASONRY / RENDER

Area
m² 48

Coats 1 2 3

Textured render
Litres use the textured masonry coverage and labour uses the textured masonry rate — off means smooth ☐

Spray render
Litres use the sprayed masonry coverage, and the masonry labour picks up the spray sundries bump. Labour time is unchanged ☐

FASCIAS & SOFFITS

Length
linear metres 14

Coats 1 2 3

Home **Measure** **On Site** **Summary**

Exterior work is priced per *item* — typically one per elevation ("Front elevation", "Rear + gable") or per job type ("Fascias all round"). Each item is a menu of exterior work; fill in only what applies:

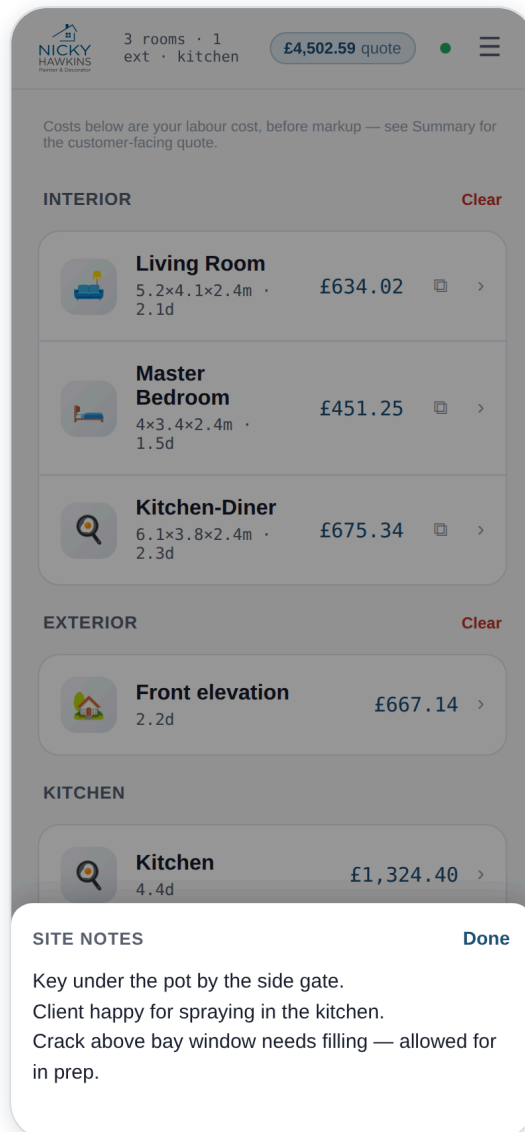
- Masonry / Render** — area in m² and coats, with toggles for **textured render** (more paint, more time) and **spray render**.
- Fascias & Soffits** — linear metres and coats.
- Exterior Windows / Doors / Garage doors** — counts and coats; windows can be added individually with size and access.
- Porch / Feature Door** — priced in days.
- Sash Window Restoration** — added per window.

- **Preparation** and **Making Good** — same idea as rooms.
- **Paint Colours** — masonry and woodwork colours for the quote.

The **Preview** at the bottom shows cost and time; **Save** adds it to the Measure list.

Site notes

Tap the  **button** (bottom left of Measure) any time to jot job notes — access arrangements, things agreed on the doorstep, snags you spotted. Notes save automatically and stay with the job.



4. Kitchen cabinet respray

On **Measure**, tap **+** → **Kitchen** to open the dedicated cabinet-spray calculator — one kitchen per job, saved automatically. Once it has anything in it, the kitchen appears as its own priced line in the Measure list and the quote.

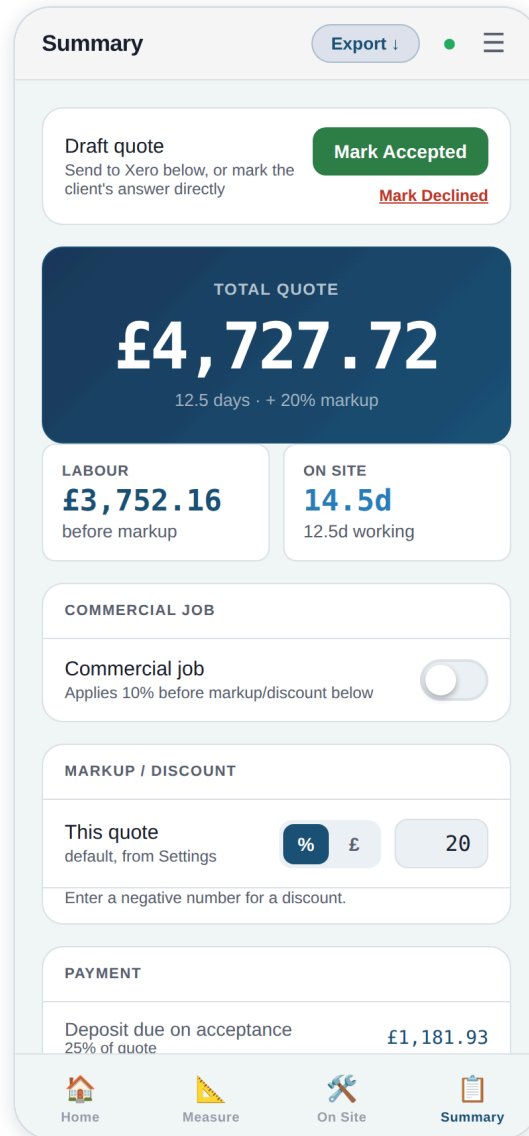
The screenshot shows the 'Kitchen' calculator interface. At the top, there's a back arrow, the title 'Kitchen', a quote chip showing '£1,589.28 quote', a green status dot, and a menu icon. The interface is divided into several sections: 'COATS' with a subtext '— applies to every item below' and a 'Coat count' selector set to '2'; 'DOORS', 'DRAWER FRONTS', 'END PANELS', and 'FILLERS', each with a right-pointing arrow; 'LINEAR ITEMS' with a subtext '— priced per metre, not per piece', containing 'Cornices metres' set to '4.2' and 'Plinths metres' set to '5.6'; 'CARCASS SPRAYING' with a toggle for 'Spray carcasses' (currently off) and a note '% uplift on doors + drawers + end panels — see Settings to tune the %'; and 'COLOUR & PRODUCT'. At the bottom is a navigation bar with icons and labels for 'Home', 'Measure' (active), 'On Site', and 'Summary'.

- **Coat count** (1–4) applies to every item below.
- Tap open **Doors**, **Drawer Fronts**, **End Panels** and **Fillers** and enter how many of each size (Small / Medium / Large / X-Large). Each size has its own base price and per-coat price — tune them in Settings → Kitchen Rates.
- **Linear items** — cornices and plinths are priced per metre.
- **Carcass spraying** — toggle on to add a percentage uplift for spraying the cabinet interiors/carcasses.
- **Colour & Product** — pick the paint for the quote and materials list.

The chip at the top shows the kitchen's running total, and the whole kitchen appears as its own line in the quote.

5. The quote (Summary)

Open  **Summary** and the job becomes a priced quote:



Summary Export

Draft quote
Send to Xero below, or mark the client's answer directly

Mark Accepted
Mark Declined

TOTAL QUOTE
£4,727.72
12.5 days · + 20% markup

LABOUR
£3,752.16
before markup

ON SITE
14.5d
12.5d working

COMMERCIAL JOB

Commercial job
Applies 10% before markup/discount below ☐

MARKUP / DISCOUNT

This quote
default, from Settings % £ **20**

Enter a negative number for a discount.

PAYMENT

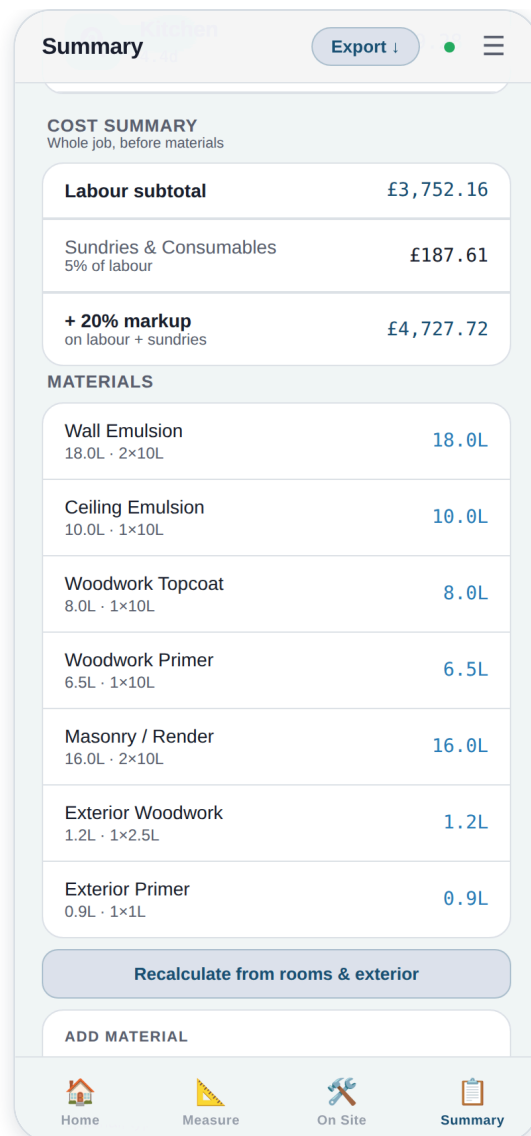
Deposit due on acceptance
25% of quote **£1,181.93**

 Home  Measure  On Site  **Summary**

The hero card shows the **total quote**, days on site, and the markup applied. Below it:

- **Labour** (before markup) and **On Site days** at a glance.
- **Commercial job** — a toggle that adds a 10% uplift before markup, for commercial rather than domestic work.
- **Markup / Discount** — this quote can override your default markup; enter a negative number for a discount.
- **Payment** — the **deposit** due on acceptance (your default % from Settings) and the **balance**. Switch the payment plan to **Multi-week** to show weekly instalments across the job.

Scroll further for the full breakdown — every room and exterior item priced, labour subtotal, sundries, markup — followed by the **Materials** list: each paint totalled in litres and converted into tins to buy.



If you change rooms after quoting, tap **Recalculate from rooms & exterior** to refresh the materials snapshot. The **Export ↓** button (top right) exports the quote as a CSV file.

Sending the quote to Xero

Expand the **Xero panel** at the top of Summary:

1. **Client name** — start typing and existing Xero contacts autocomplete; picking one pulls in their details. Or type a new name and fill in phone, email and address (address autocompletes if Google Places is set up).
2. Add a **Reference** if you use them.
3. Tap **Send to Xero**. The quote is created in Xero, ready to send to the client from there.

If you edit the job afterwards, the button becomes **"Update quote Q-*nnn* in Xero"** so re-sending updates the *same* quote — with a "Send as a NEW quote instead" option when you genuinely want a second version.

When the client answers

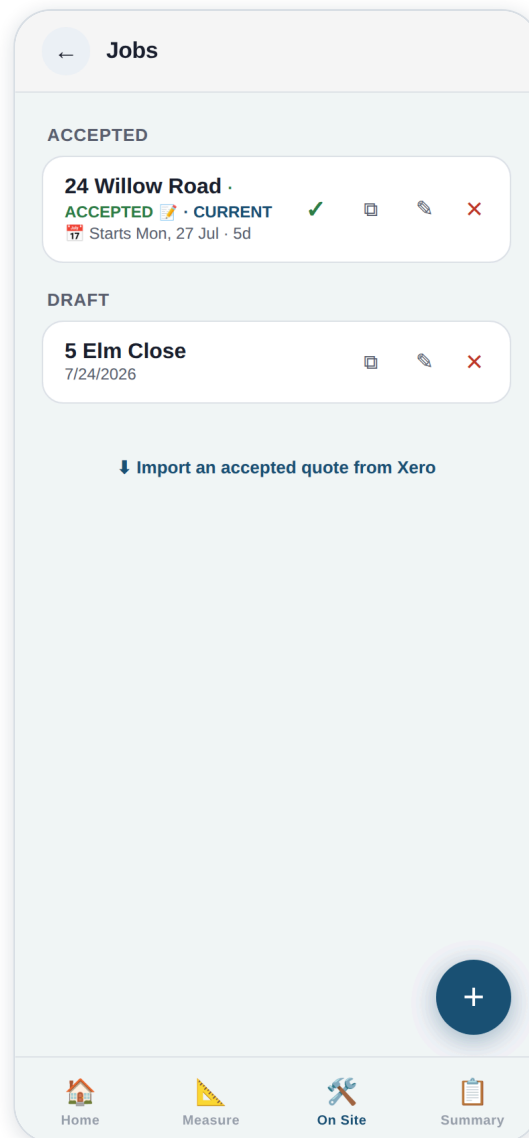
At the top of Summary:

- **Mark Accepted** — the job moves to Accepted (synced to Xero), and scheduling and On Site tracking unlock.
- **Mark Declined** — the job files itself away under Declined.

Quotes that sit unanswered longer than your "chase quotes after" setting (default 14 days) pop up on Home so nothing slips.

6. Jobs

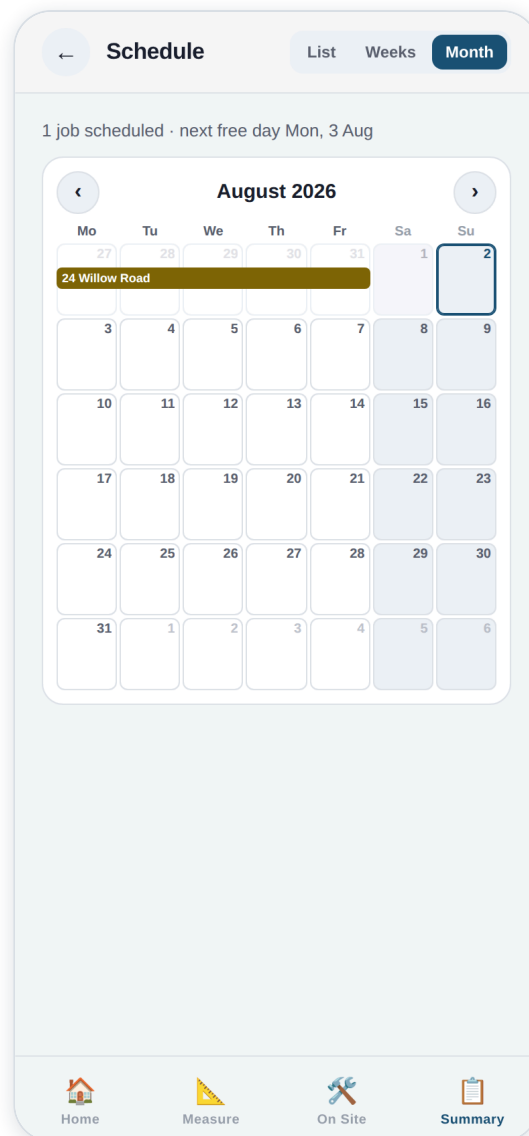
Menu (≡) → **Jobs**. The app holds any number of jobs; the one you're working on is marked **CURRENT**, and everything on Measure, Kitchen, Summary and On Site belongs to it. Tap another job to switch.



- Jobs group by status: **Accepted, Quoted, Draft**, with finished work (Completed / Invoiced / Declined) dimmed below.
- **+** starts a new job. Each job is fully separate — its own rooms, kitchen, colours and materials.
- Row shortcuts: ✓ mark completed, duplicate, rename, and × delete.
- **Import an accepted quote from Xero** — took the job on before the app existed? Import the Xero quote and it becomes a job here, with the agreed price as the record.

7. Schedule

Menu (☰) → **Schedule** — or tap **Schedule** > on an accepted job's Summary, which offers the next free slot automatically.



- Switch between **List**, **Weeks** and **Month** views. Jobs appear as coloured bars across their booked days; UK bank holidays are marked, and weekends are greyed out unless you've turned on **Work Saturdays** in Settings.
- **Tap a job's bar** → Open job, **Move start date** (then tap the new day), or **Unschedule**.
- **Tap an empty day** → start a job there, or **block days** for holidays and time off.
- The header tells you your **next free day** at all times.

See jobs in your phone calendar: Settings → Scheduling → turn on **Calendar feed**, then tap the link to copy it and subscribe in your calendar app. Booked jobs then appear alongside everything else in your life.

8. On Site — running the job

Once a job is accepted, the 🏠 **On Site** tab is your day-to-day companion:

The screenshot shows the 'On Site' mobile app interface for a job titled '24 Willow Road'. At the top, there's a header with 'On Site' and an 'Invoice >' button. Below the header, the job title '24 Willow Road' is displayed with a green 'Accepted' status and a calendar icon showing 'Mon, 27 Jul · 5d'. A green 'Mark Completed' button is next to it. A table shows financial data: 'Estimated' at £0.00, 'Actual (so far)' at £0.00, and 'Variance' at £0.00, with a note 'Everything ticked off'. The 'TIME ON SITE' section shows 'No days logged yet · estimated ~14.5 on site' and a blue '+ Log today (full day)' button, with a link to 'Log a different day'. The 'MATERIALS' section states 'No materials yet. Recalculate the snapshot on Summary, or add what you bought below.' The 'ADD MATERIAL THE ESTIMATE MISSED' section has input fields for 'Product' (with a 'Search...' button), 'Description' (with 'e.g. Extra r' as an example), and 'Colour' (with a dropdown showing 'No colour'). At the bottom is a navigation bar with icons for 'Home', 'Measure', 'On Site' (active), and 'Summary'.

- **Estimated vs Actual** — the card at the top tracks what the materials are really costing against what you quoted, with the variance.
- **Time on Site** — tap **+ Log today (full day)** at the end of each day (or *Log a different day* to back-fill). This builds the true labour record for the job.
- **Materials** — the quote's materials list becomes a shopping list. Tick items off as you buy them, and correct quantities/prices to what you actually paid. The badge on the On Site tab shows how many items are still to buy.
- **Add material the estimate missed** — extra sundries or a forgotten tin: search the product, set the price, done. It's tracked for the final invoice.
- **Variations** — the client asks for "just one more room" mid-job? Add the room (or exterior item) on Measure and flick its **Variation** toggle. It's priced with the same engine but kept separate from the accepted quote, and appears in its own Variations card here and on the invoice.
- **Invoice >** (top right) shows the materials list formatted for invoicing, with a **Copy** button.

When the work's done, tap **Mark Completed** — the job moves on, and Home reminds you it needs invoicing until you do.

9. The final invoice

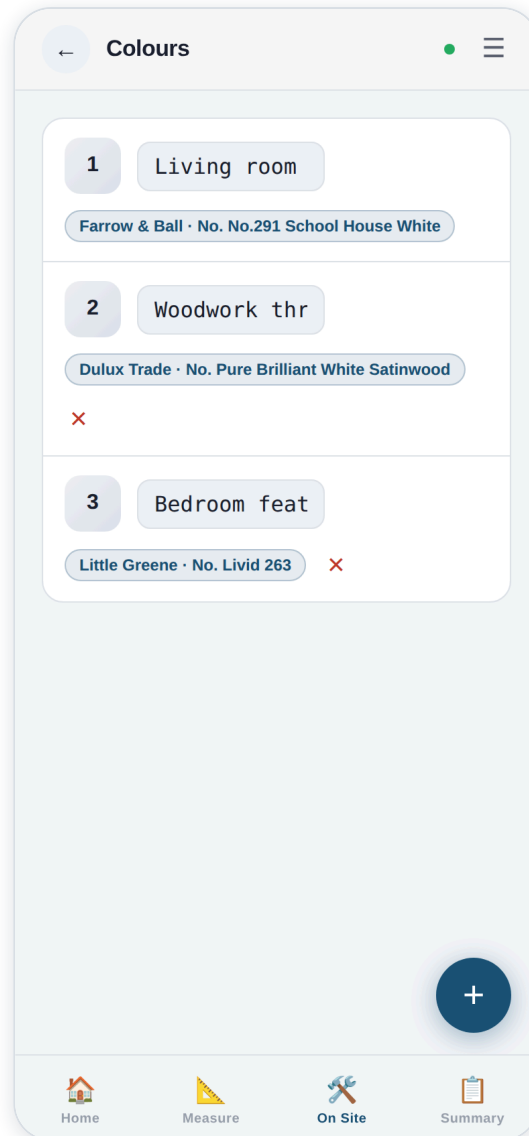
On a **Completed** job, On Site shows **Build final invoice**. The builder assembles the whole money story in one list:

- labour **as quoted** (the price you agreed, not the hours it took),
- plus **variations**,
- plus the **actual materials** used (from your ticked-off list),
- minus the **deposit** and any other deductions.

Review the lines, adjust anything, then send — the app writes **one draft invoice into Xero** and marks the job **Invoiced**. You approve and send the invoice from Xero as usual, so nothing goes to the client without your say-so.

10. Colours

Menu (☰) → **Colours** — the job's colour schedule. As you and the client settle on colours, note each one here: a label for where it goes, plus brand and colour name from the built-in library of common UK trade colours (Farrow & Ball, Dulux, Little Greene, RAL Classic and more).



Numbered colour slots are what the room forms' colour chips point at — so "wall colour 1" in a room always means colour 1 on this list. Decide the colours once, and every surface that uses them updates.

11. Settings

Menu (≡) → **Settings**. Every number the calculator uses lives here, so a change applies to all future pricing. Everything saves as you type.

Settings

BUSINESS

Business name

shown in the app header, on the login screen and in the calendar feed

e.g. J.

Logo

optional — shown instead of the name in the header

Upload...

YOUR RATES

Day Rate

£ per day

300

Hours Per Day

7

Markup

%

20

Commercial job adjustment

% — default when a quote's Commercial job toggle is on, applied before markup/discount

10

Sundries & Consumables

% of labour, before markup

5

Spray sundries bump

extra % on sprayed rooms' labour — masking film, tape & paper

3

Deposit

0

Home

Measure

On Site

Summary

Section	What's in it
Business	Your business name and logo — shown in the app header, on the sign-in screen and in the calendar feed
Your Rates	Day rate, hours per day, markup %, sundries %, spray sundries bump, deposit %, commercial job adjustment, and how many days before an unanswered quote gets flagged
Scheduling	Daily overhead minutes, schedule buffer, Work Saturdays, bank-holiday region, and the calendar feed
Coverage Rates	m ² per litre for each paint type — the heart of the materials maths
Time Rates	Minutes per m ² / per item for walls, ceilings, woodwork, doors, windows, radiators... the heart of the labour maths
Wallpaper Rates	Per-roll pricing, ceiling and staircase multipliers, minimum charge
Exterior Rates	Rates and coverage for masonry, fascias, exterior windows and doors
Kitchen Rates	The size-by-size price table for doors, drawers, panels, cornices, plinths, carcass %
Xero Integration	Connect / Disconnect Xero
Materials (Xero Items)	Refresh your product list from Xero and set the default product for each role
Appearance	Light / Dark / Auto theme
Backup	Export and import everything — see below

Calibrate as you go: after a few jobs, compare the logged time and actual materials on On Site with what was estimated, and nudge the time and coverage rates here. The estimates get sharper with every job.

12. Backups

Settings → **Backup**:

- **Export everything** downloads a single JSON file containing every job, room, setting and colour. Do this regularly — Home will nag you when the last backup is getting old.
- **Import backup** restores from a file, adding to what's already there.

The **Clear Everything** button in Settings does exactly what it says across all jobs — it's for starting completely fresh, not for deleting one job (do that from the Jobs screen). Export a backup first.

13. Tips & troubleshooting

The dot in the top bar is your sync status: green = everything saved to the server, amber = saving now, red = offline. If you lose signal mid-measure, keep working — changes are kept on your phone ("Offline — changes saved on this phone") and pushed up when the connection returns; the menu's sync line confirms with "All changes synced ✓".

A price looks wrong? Work backwards: room Preview → Summary breakdown → Settings rates. The calculation is always *areas × time rates × day rate*, plus *areas ÷ coverage = litres → tins*, plus sundries and markup. One of those numbers will be the culprit — usually a coverage or time rate that doesn't match how you actually work.

Xero button not working? Tokens occasionally expire for good if the app hasn't talked to Xero in a long while. Settings → Disconnect Xero → Connect Xero puts it right in under a minute.

Sent a quote, then client wants changes? Just edit the rooms and hit **Update quote Q-nnn in Xero** on Summary — same quote number, new figures.

Materials list out of date after edits? Tap **Recalculate from rooms & exterior** on Summary. (The app deliberately doesn't do this behind your back once you've started ticking things off on site.)

Extra work mid-job? Always add it as a **Variation** rather than editing the accepted rooms — the original quote stays honest, and the extra shows separately on the final invoice where the client expects to see it.

Manual for NH Estimator v2.2.5. Screenshots taken from the app with example data.

*Keeping this manual up to date: edit this file, then run `npm run build:manual` to regenerate the PDF edition (*NH-Estimator-User-Manual.pdf*) and commit both together. The cover picks up the app version and date automatically.*